fines and collecting fees, etc.) to Rs 2.16 lakh crore as against the actuals of Rs 1.27 lakh crore in 2019–20.

Every component of non-tax revenues and non-debt capital receipts underperformed during the year. The government reduced the targets massively in the revised estimates.

Estimated revenues from dividends and surpluses were reduced from Rs 1,55,395 crore to Rs 96,544 crore. Budgeted revenues of Rs 2,16,277 crore for other non-tax receipts were revised to just Rs 98,024 crore. Non-tax revenues as such were scaled down from Rs 3,85,017 crore to Rs 2,10,653 crore, a reduction of 46 per cent.

Likewise, in non-debt capital receipts, disinvestment revenue estimates were reduced from Rs 2.10 lakh crore to Rs 32,000 crore, a slash of Rs 1.78 lakh crore, or 85 per cent.

Forget 2019–20 when these transactions were supposed to have been carried out, the government could not accomplish a single sale even in 2020–21. Though COVID-19 had a role to play, the markets reached an all-time high and IPO activity in the private sector was at its highest in many years.

Everything That Could Have Gone Wrong Went Wrong in Disinvestment

The government could not complete even a single strategic sale transaction during the year.

Some steps were indeed taken to carry the process of privatization/strategic sale further. Expressions of Interest (EoIs) were invited for Air India, BPCL and SCI. Some interest was received as well, but lacked enthusiasm.

CPSEs were asked to pay as much dividend as possible. They paid two interim dividends in quite a few cases in 2020–21. Yet, as their profitability had suffered, overall dividend receipts were lower than the previous year.